

NEXACORP
ENTERPRISES

EMPLOYEE LEAVE POLICY
Human Resources | People Operations Division

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1.0 POLICY STATEMENT

NexaCorp Enterprises (hereinafter referred to as 'the Company') recognizes that employees require adequate time away from work for rest, recuperation, personal matters, and family responsibilities. This Employee Leave Policy establishes a standardized, transparent, and equitable framework for all categories of leave available to eligible employees across all business units, regional offices, and corporate locations of NexaCorp Enterprises.

The Company is committed to balancing the personal needs of employees with the operational requirements of the business. This policy sets forth the entitlements, eligibility criteria, accrual mechanisms, approval workflows, escalation procedures, and compliance obligations governing employee leave.

All employees, reporting managers, HR Business Partners, and HR Operations personnel are required to adhere strictly to this policy. Any deviation from the stated guidelines must be approved in writing by the HR leadership and documented in the employee's personal file.

2.0 APPLICABILITY & SCOPE

2.1 Applicability

- This policy applies to all full-time permanent employees of NexaCorp Enterprises.
- Contractual employees, consultants, and interns are governed by their respective agreements and are not entitled to benefits under this policy unless explicitly stated.
- This policy is applicable across all locations including Corporate Headquarters, Regional Offices, and remote work designations.
- Employees on deputation to client sites remain governed by NexaCorp's leave policy unless a separate agreement is in force.

2.2 Scope

- Scope includes all leave categories described in Section 5.0.
- All employee levels: L1 (Junior Associate) through L10 (C-Suite Executive).
- All departments including Technology, Finance, Operations, Sales, HR, Legal, and Marketing.

3.0 OBJECTIVES

- To provide a comprehensive and fair leave framework that supports employee well-being.
- To standardize leave entitlements and approval workflows across all business units.
- To ensure compliance with applicable labour laws including the Shops and Establishments Act, Factories Act, and Maternity Benefit Act.
- To enable transparent and efficient leave management through the HR Information System (HRIS).
- To minimize operational disruption by defining clear approval timelines and escalation paths.
- To promote responsible utilization of leave entitlements without abuse or fraudulent misuse.

4.0 DEFINITIONS & GLOSSARY

Term	Definition
Leave Year	The period from 1st January to 31st December of each calendar year.
Accrual	The gradual accumulation of leave credits over a defined period.

Term	Definition
Carry Forward	Transfer of unused leave credits to the next leave year, subject to defined limits.
Leave Encashment	Monetary compensation provided in lieu of accumulated but unutilized leave.
Reporting Manager	The immediate supervisor to whom an employee directly reports in the organizational hierarchy.
HR Business Partner (HRBP)	Dedicated HR representative aligned to a specific business unit.
HRIS	Human Resource Information System - the Company centralized leave management platform.
Probation Period	The initial employment period of six (6) months during which performance and suitability are assessed.
Notice Period	The period between submission of resignation and the last working day as per the employment contract.
L1–L10	NexaCorp employee grade levels from L1 (Junior Associate) to L10 (C-Suite).
Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)	A leave day granted in lieu of working on a weekly off or public holiday.
Sabbatical	An extended period of paid or partially paid leave granted to senior employees for professional development.

5.0 LEAVE CATEGORIES & ENTITLEMENTS

NexaCorp Enterprises provides the following categories of leave to eligible employees. Leave entitlements are calculated on a per-calendar-year basis and are credited to the employee's leave account at the beginning of the leave year or on the date of joining for new hires, on a pro-rated basis.

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Accrual	Max Carry Forward	Encashable
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	Upfront (Jan)	0 days (lapses)	No
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	Upfront (Jan)	5 days	No
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	1.5 days/month	30 days	Yes (up to 15)
Maternity Leave (ML)	182 days (26 wks)	N/A	N/A	No
Paternity Leave (PL)	10 days	N/A	0 days	No
Bereavement Leave (BL)	5 days per event	N/A	0 days	No
Marriage Leave	5 days (once)	N/A	0 days	No
Compensatory Off	As earned	Per event	5 days	No
Sabbatical Leave	Up to 90 days	Eligibility-based	N/A	No
Unpaid Leave (UL)	As approved	N/A	N/A	No

5.1 Casual Leave (CL)

- Casual Leave is granted for unplanned, short-duration personal emergencies.
- Employees are entitled to 12 Casual Leave days per calendar year, credited on 1st January.
- Casual Leave cannot be availed for more than 3 consecutive days without supporting documentation.
- Half-day Casual Leave is permitted with prior approval of the Reporting Manager.
- Unused Casual Leave lapses at year-end and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

- Casual Leave cannot be combined with Earned Leave or other paid leave categories unless specifically approved by the HR Business Partner.

5.2 Sick Leave (SL)

- Sick Leave is granted for illness, medical appointments, or hospitalization.
- 10 Sick Leave days are provided annually per employee.
- For Sick Leave availed for more than 2 consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner must be submitted within 3 working days of return.
- Up to 5 unused Sick Leave days may be carried forward to the next year; total Sick Leave balance shall not exceed 15 days at any time.
- Sick Leave cannot be encashed under any circumstances.
- Abuse of Sick Leave may result in disciplinary action under the Company's Code of Conduct.

5.3 Earned Leave (EL)

- Earned Leave (also referred to as Privilege Leave or Annual Leave) is the primary paid time-off entitlement.
- EL accrues at the rate of 1.5 days per completed calendar month of service, totalling 18 days per year.
- Employees with less than one year of service receive EL on a pro-rated basis from their date of joining.
- EL must be applied at least 7 calendar days in advance for planned leave; exceptions are subject to Reporting Manager's approval.
- A maximum of 30 Earned Leave days may be accumulated in the employee's leave balance at any point.
- Up to 15 days of Earned Leave may be encashed per year during the annual leave encashment window (October–November).
- Employees separating from the Company shall receive encashment of accrued EL balance, subject to a maximum of 60 days.

5.4 Maternity Leave (ML)

- Female employees with at least 80 days of service in the preceding 12 months are entitled to 182 days (26 weeks) of paid Maternity Leave as per the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017.
- In case of miscarriage or medical termination of pregnancy, 6 weeks of paid leave shall be granted.
- Adoption: Female employees adopting a child below 3 months of age are entitled to 12 weeks of paid Maternity Leave.
- Surrogacy: Commissioning mothers are entitled to 12 weeks of paid leave from the date of delivery.
- Extension of Maternity Leave beyond the statutory period may be considered as Unpaid Leave with HRBP and CPO approval.
- Medical documentation confirming the expected date of delivery must be submitted to HR not later than the end of the 7th month of pregnancy.

5.5 Paternity Leave (PL)

- Male employees are entitled to 10 working days of paid Paternity Leave within 3 months of childbirth or legal adoption.
- Paternity Leave may be availed in one continuous block or in two separate periods not shorter than 3 days each.
- Paternity Leave does not carry forward and must be availed within 3 months of the qualifying event.
- Proof of birth (birth certificate or hospital document) must be submitted within 30 days.

5.6 Bereavement Leave

- 5 working days of paid Bereavement Leave are granted on the death of an immediate family member.
- Immediate family includes: spouse, children, parents, parents-in-law, and siblings.
- For extended family (grandparents, uncles, aunts), 2 days of Bereavement Leave are granted.

- Bereavement Leave does not carry forward, cannot be encashed, and is not restricted to once per year.
- Documentation (death certificate) must be submitted to HR within 7 working days of return.

5.7 Marriage Leave

- 5 consecutive working days of paid Marriage Leave are granted for the employee's own marriage.
- Marriage Leave is a one-time entitlement during the entire tenure with the Company.
- Proof of marriage (marriage certificate) must be submitted within 30 days of availing the leave.
- Marriage Leave may be clubbed with Earned Leave or Casual Leave, subject to Reporting Manager's approval.

5.8 Compensatory Off (Comp-Off)

- Comp-Off is granted when an employee is required to work on a weekly off day or a declared public holiday.
- Comp-Off must be claimed within 60 days of working the extra day; unclaimed Comp-Offs lapse thereafter.
- Comp-Off is approved by the Reporting Manager and must be recorded in the HRIS within 3 working days of the extra working day.
- A maximum of 5 Comp-Off days may be accumulated at any time.
- Comp-Off cannot be encashed or carried forward beyond 60 days.

5.9 Sabbatical Leave

- Sabbatical Leave is available to employees at Grade L6 and above with a minimum of 5 years of continuous service with NexaCorp.
- Sabbatical may be granted for a duration of 30 to 90 calendar days for approved purposes: higher education, research, professional certification, or social service.
- Sabbatical Leave requires approval from the Department Head, HR Business Partner, and the Chief People Officer (CPO).
- During sabbatical, the employee receives 50% of the Basic Salary; other allowances are suspended.
- The employee must rejoin the Company for a minimum of 2 years after the sabbatical. Failure to do so results in recovery of sabbatical compensation.
- Only one sabbatical may be availed during the entire tenure with NexaCorp.

5.10 Unpaid Leave

- Unpaid Leave may be granted at the Company's discretion for circumstances not covered by other leave categories.
- Unpaid Leave requires approval from the Reporting Manager, HR Business Partner, and HR Head.
- During unpaid leave, salary is not paid; however, statutory benefits such as PF and health insurance continue.
- Unpaid Leave does not count toward service continuity for leave accrual or statutory gratuity.
- Unpaid Leave of more than 30 days in a year requires CPO approval.

6.0 ELIGIBILITY RULES

Leave Type	Minimum Service	Employee Level	Contract / Probation Eligible?
Casual Leave	0 months (pro-rated)	L1 – L10	No (probation: CL only from Month 3)
Sick Leave	0 months (pro-rated)	L1 – L10	Probation: Yes Contract: No
Earned Leave	1 month	L1 – L10	Probation: Accrues, availed after confirmation

Leave Type	Minimum Service	Employee Level	Contract / Probation Eligible?
Maternity Leave	80 days in 12 months	L1 – L10 (female)	No
Paternity Leave	At birth/adoption event	L1 – L10 (male)	No
Bereavement Leave	0 months	L1 – L10	Probation: Yes Contract: Case-by-case
Marriage Leave	6 months	L1 – L10	No
Compensatory Off	0 months (event-based)	L1 – L10	Probation: Yes Contract: Yes
Sabbatical Leave	5 years continuous	L6 – L10	No
Unpaid Leave	Manager discretion	L1 – L10	Probation: Case-by-case

7.0 LEAVE ACCRUAL MECHANISM

Leave accrual is the process by which employees accumulate leave credits over time. NexaCorp's HRIS automatically calculates and credits leave balances in accordance with the following rules:

- Casual Leave: 12 days are credited in full at the beginning of the calendar year (1st January) or on the date of joining for new employees on a pro-rated basis of 1 CL per completed month.
- Sick Leave: 10 days are credited in full at the beginning of the calendar year or pro-rated for new joiners at 1 SL per completed month.
- Earned Leave: 1.5 days accrue per completed calendar month. Accrual begins from the first day of employment. Leave is credited to the employee's HRIS balance on the last day of each month.
- For employees who join after the 15th of the month, accrual begins from the following month.
- Employees on Long Leave (Unpaid Leave or Leave Without Pay) do not accrue Earned Leave for the duration of the long leave.
- Accrual is subject to a maximum cap as detailed in the Leave Entitlement Table (Section 5.0).
- Leave balances may be viewed in real-time through the NexaCorp HRIS Employee Self-Service Portal or the NexaCorp Mobile Application.

Month	EL Accrued (Current Month)	Cumulative EL Balance
January	1.5 days	1.5 days
February	1.5 days	3.0 days
March	1.5 days	4.5 days
June	1.5 days	9.0 days
September	1.5 days	13.5 days
December	1.5 days	18.0 days

Note: Illustration assumes employee joined on 1 January with no prior leave.

8.0 LEAVE APPROVAL WORKFLOW

All leave requests must be submitted through the NexaCorp HRIS portal or the NexaCorp Mobile Application. Paper-based or verbal leave requests are not accepted unless the HRIS is unavailable due to a system outage, in which case email to the Reporting Manager and HR inbox is permissible.

Step	Actor	Action	SLA
1	Employee	Submit leave request in HRIS with reason, dates, and supporting docs if applicable.	
2	System (HRIS)	Auto-notifies Reporting Manager via email and in-app notification.	Immediate
3	Reporting Manager	Reviews, approves, or rejects the leave request.	Within 2 business days
4	HRIS System	Updates employee leave balance and sends confirmation to employee.	Employee post-approval
5	HR Operations	Monthly audit of leave records; flags anomalies to HR Business Partner.	As Required

8.1 Special Approval Requirements

Leave Category	Approval Authority
Maternity Leave	HR Business Partner + HR Head
Sabbatical Leave	Department Head + HRBP + CPO
Unpaid Leave (> 30 days)	Reporting Manager + HR Head + CPO
Leave During Notice Period	HR Head (Special Approval)
International Remote + Leave Combo	Reporting Manager + HRBP + Legal
Bereavement Leave (extended)	HR Business Partner

9.0 LEAVE CANCELLATION PROCESS

- An employee may cancel an approved leave request through the HRIS self-service portal prior to the commencement of the leave period.
- Leave cancellation requests submitted after the leave has commenced will not be honoured except in exceptional circumstances requiring HR Head approval.
- If an employee returns to work before the approved leave end date, the employee must update the HRIS with the actual return date. The excess leave balance is automatically restored.
- Repeated cancellation of approved leave (more than 3 times in a quarter) may be flagged by the HRIS and reviewed by the HR Business Partner.
- Cancelled leave days are automatically restored to the employee's leave balance within 1 business day of HRIS processing.

10.0 CARRY FORWARD & LEAVE LAPSE RULES

At the end of each calendar year (31 December), unused leave balances are processed as follows:

Leave Type	Carry Forward Allowed	Maximum Carry Forward	Lapse Rule
Casual Leave	No	NIL	All unused CL lapses on 31 December.
Sick Leave	Yes	5 days	Balance above 5 days lapses. Total SL cap: 15 days.
Earned Leave	Yes	30 days total balance	Balance exceeding 30 days is subject to encashment or lapse as per policy.
Bereavement Leave	No	NIL	Unused days lapse (event-based; N/A).
Marriage Leave	No	NIL	One-time entitlement; lapses if not availed.

Leave Type	Carry Forward Allowed	Maximum Carry Forward	Lapse Rule
Compensatory Off	Limited	5 days (60-day validity)	Comp-off lapses after 60 days from the working day.
Paternity Leave	No	NIL	Must be availed within 3 months of event.
Sabbatical Leave	N/A	N/A	Eligibility-based; not an annual entitlement.

Note: Employees are encouraged to plan and avail Casual Leave during the calendar year to avoid lapse.

11.0 LEAVE ENCASHMENT POLICY

- Only Earned Leave (EL) is eligible for encashment.
- The leave encashment window opens annually from 1 October to 30 November. Employees may submit encashment requests for up to 15 EL days.
- Leave encashment is calculated as: $\text{Encashment Value} = (\text{Basic Salary} / 26) \times \text{Number of EL Days}$.
- Encashment payout is processed with the November payroll.
- Employees separating from the Company (resignation, retirement, or termination with settlement) will receive encashment of accrued EL balance up to a maximum of 60 days.
- Leave encashment is subject to applicable income tax as per the prevailing tax laws.
- Employees on active PIP (Performance Improvement Plan) are not eligible for the annual leave encashment window.

12.0 LEAVE DURING NOTICE PERIOD

- Leave during the notice period is strongly discouraged as it disrupts handover and knowledge transfer processes.
- Casual Leave and Sick Leave during the notice period may be approved at the Reporting Manager's discretion; however, such leave will extend the notice period by an equivalent number of days.
- Earned Leave during the notice period is not permitted. Accrued EL is encashed as part of the full-and-final settlement.
- Pre-approved leave that was sanctioned before submission of resignation may be honoured without extending the notice period, subject to HR Head's concurrence.
- An employee on maternity leave may serve the notice period after maternity leave concludes. The resignation date and notice period will be adjusted accordingly.
- Any unapproved absence during the notice period will be treated as Leave Without Pay (LWP) and deducted from the final settlement.

13.0 LEAVE DURING PROBATION

- Employees on probation are eligible for a limited set of leave categories to support them during their initial employment period.
- Probation employees are eligible for Sick Leave from Day 1 and Casual Leave from the beginning of the third month of service.
- Earned Leave accrues from the first day of employment but may only be availed after confirmation of employment (post-probation).
- Probation employees are not eligible for Maternity Leave, Paternity Leave, Marriage Leave, Sabbatical Leave, or Leave Encashment.
- Extended absence during probation (more than 5 consecutive days) may result in extension of the probation period by the same number of days.

- All leave during probation must be approved by the Reporting Manager and noted by the HR Business Partner.
- Probation employees are eligible for Bereavement Leave on a case-by-case basis with HR Business Partner approval.

14.0 FRAUDULENT LEAVE & DISCIPLINARY ACTION

NexaCorp Enterprises maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward fraudulent leave claims. The following actions constitute leave fraud and are subject to disciplinary proceedings:

- Submitting false or forged medical certificates to claim Sick Leave.
- Claiming Bereavement Leave without genuine bereavement.
- Availing leave without prior approval and subsequently claiming it as planned leave.
- Misrepresenting the reason for leave to obtain approval.
- Repeated pattern of unauthorized absence disguised as approved leave.

Violation Severity	Action Taken
First instance – Minor (e.g., late submission of medical certificate)	Written warning; Leave recorded as LWP
Second instance – Moderate (e.g., forged documents)	Final written warning; Salary deduction; PIP initiation
Third instance / Major (e.g., repeated fraud)	Termination of employment; Legal action if applicable

15.0 ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Stakeholder	Responsibilities
Employee	Submit leave requests accurately and on time via HRIS; submit supporting documents; ensure work coverage.
Reporting Manager	Review and action leave requests within 2 business days; ensure team coverage; flag leave abuse to HRBP.
HR Business Partner	Advise on policy interpretation; monitor leave patterns; resolve disputes between employees and managers.
HR Operations	Maintain leave records; process encashments; conduct audits; update HRIS configuration.
Payroll Team	Ensure leave deductions and encashments are processed accurately in monthly payroll.
IT Team	Maintain HRIS availability; resolve technical issues related to leave application; manage access controls.
Chief People Officer	Final authority on policy exceptions; review escalations; approve sabbatical and extended unpaid leave.

16.0 ESCALATION MATRIX

Escalation Level	Trigger Condition	Escalated To	Resolution SLA
Level 1	Reporting Manager does not action leave request within 2 days	HRBP	1 business day
Level 2	HRBP unable to resolve; employee-manager conflict over leave	HRBP + Reporting Manager	3 business days
Level 3	Systemic leave fraud detected; legal implications	Chief People Officer + Legal	5 business days
Level 4	Policy dispute; grievance escalation	Grievance Redressal Committee	10 business days

17.0 SLA TIMELINES

Activity	Responsible Party	SLA (Business Days)
Leave Request Approval / Rejection	Reporting Manager	2 days
Leave Balance Update in HRIS	HRIS System	Real-time
Medical Certificate Submission	Employee	3 days from return
Comp-Off Request Submission	Employee	3 days from extra working day
Leave Encashment Processing	HR Operations + Payroll	With November Payroll
Grievance Resolution (Leave)	HR Business Partner	5 days
HRIS Access Restoration (Technical Issue)	IT Helpdesk	4 hours (Priority 1)
Full & Final Settlement Leave Encashment	HR Ops + Finance	30 days from LWD

18.0 EXCEPTIONS & SPECIAL CIRCUMSTANCES

- All exceptions to this policy must be documented and approved by the HR Head. Verbal exceptions are not valid.
- In the event of a natural disaster, public health emergency, or force majeure event, the Company may announce emergency leave provisions as communicated by the CPO's office.
- Employees recalled from approved leave due to urgent business requirements shall have the leave days fully credited back to their balance.
- Employees suffering from a critical illness requiring extended hospitalization may be granted extended Sick Leave beyond the standard entitlement, subject to CPO approval and medical evidence.

19.0 COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENTS

- This policy complies with the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act, 2017; Shops and Establishments Act (applicable State rules); Factories Act, 1948; and applicable labour codes.
- HR Operations conducts a semi-annual audit of leave records to ensure compliance and accurate HRIS data.
- Non-compliance by employees results in leave reclassification as Leave Without Pay (LWP) and may attract disciplinary action.
- Non-compliance by Reporting Managers (e.g., failure to act on leave requests within SLA) is flagged in the manager's performance review.
- The Company reserves the right to amend this policy in line with regulatory changes. Employees will be notified at least 30 days in advance of any changes.

20.0 FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Q: How many casual leaves are allowed annually?

A: Employees are entitled to 12 Casual Leave days per calendar year. These are credited upfront on 1st January and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

Q: Can I carry forward unused Earned Leave?

A: Yes. Up to 30 days of Earned Leave may be accumulated in total. Unused EL above this cap is subject to encashment during the October–November window or lapses if not encashed.

Q: What happens if I do not submit a medical certificate for Sick Leave?

A: If a medical certificate is not submitted within 3 working days of return from Sick Leave exceeding 2 consecutive days, the leave will be reclassified as Leave Without Pay (LWP).

Q: Can probation employees apply for Earned Leave?

A: Earned Leave accrues from day one of employment but can only be availed after confirmation of employment. Probation employees cannot take EL during the probation period.

Q: Who approves sabbatical leave?

A: Sabbatical Leave requires sequential approvals from the Department Head, HR Business Partner, and ultimately the Chief People Officer (CPO).

Q: How many earned leaves can be carried forward?

A: A maximum of 30 days of Earned Leave can be accumulated at any point. New accruals beyond this cap trigger the encashment-or-lapse rule.

Q: Can I take leave during my notice period?

A: Casual Leave and Sick Leave may be approved during notice periods at the Reporting Manager's discretion, but such leave typically extends the notice period by an equivalent number of days. Earned Leave is not permissible during notice periods.

APPENDIX A – LEAVE SCENARIOS & EXAMPLES

Scenario 1: Employee Combining Casual and Earned Leave

Ramesh (L3, Software Engineer) wants to take 7 days off from 20–28 March. He has 3 CL and 9 EL in balance. He applies for 3 CL + 4 EL. His Reporting Manager approves within 1 day. Ramesh's leave balances are updated in HRIS: CL = 0, EL = 5. No additional approvals are required as the combination is within permissible rules.

Scenario 2: Sick Leave Without Medical Certificate

Priya (L2, Finance Analyst) takes 4 consecutive days of Sick Leave but does not submit a medical certificate within the 3-day window. HR Operations flags the absence. The HRIS auto-reclassifies the leave as LWP. Priya receives a system notification and has 2 additional days to submit the certificate before the payroll cut-off.

Scenario 3: Sabbatical Leave Request

Vikram (L7, Principal Architect, 8 years of service) requests a 60-day sabbatical for a professional certification programme. He initiates the request in HRIS. Department Head approves within 3 days. HRBP reviews and endorses within 2 days. CPO grants final approval within 5 days. Vikram receives 50% of Basic Salary during the sabbatical period and signs a 2-year re-employment undertaking.

Scenario 4: Leave During Probation

Anjali (L1, HR Executive, 2 months into probation) falls ill and needs 3 days off. She applies for Sick Leave in HRIS. Her Reporting Manager approves. Since she is on probation, she is not eligible for Earned Leave. Her SL balance is debited. She submits a medical certificate upon return. HR notes the absence but it does not trigger probation extension since it is under 5 days.

Scenario 5: Fraudulent Sick Leave

Suresh (L4, Operations Manager) submits a forged medical certificate for 5 days of Sick Leave. A routine audit by HR Operations detects inconsistencies. HR raises an inquiry. Suresh is issued a final written warning, the leave is reclassified as LWP, salary is deducted accordingly, and he is placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) for 90 days.